

7. [Maximum mark: 8]

Consider the differential equation

$$\frac{dy}{dx} = y^2 \cos^2 x, \quad y \neq 0$$

The solutions to this differential equation can be expressed in the form

$$y = \frac{a}{2x + \sin 2x + b},$$

where a and b are constants such that $a \in \mathbb{Z}$ and $b \in \mathbb{R}$.

(a) By solving the differential equation, find the value of a . [6]

(b) Given that $y = 1$ when $x = \frac{\pi}{2}$, find the value of b . [2]

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